1.1 SHORT AND LONG SYLLABLES

Before the formal introduction of *chanda* in the next chapter (*Chapter 2*) the underlying basics as discussed below (Guru, 2017; Pandey, 2015).

Syllable: A vowel with or without one or more consonants is considered as one *syllable*. A syllable can be short (*Laghu or L*) or long (*Guru or G*), depending on whether its vowel is short or long.

Short syllables

The vowels अ [*a*], इ [*i*], उ [*u*] and ऋ [*ṛ*] are short. Whenever any of these is used separately or with a consonant, it will be considered as a short syllable. For example, क [*ka*], कि [*ki*], etc. are short syllables. The numeral symbol *1* is used to represent a short syllable in scansion and metrical analysis.

Long syllables

The vowels आ [*ā*], ई [*ī*], ऊ [*ū*], ए [*e*], ऐ [*ai*], ओ [*o*], औ [*au*] are long. Whenever any of these is used in a verse separately or with a consonant, it will be considered as long. For example, का [*kā*], की [*kī*] etc. are long syllables. The numeral symbol *2* is used to represent a long syllable in scansion and metrical analysis.

In special cases a short vowel gets the practical status of long under the following three conditions:

(1) If a vowel is followed by an *anusvāra*. For example, कं [*kaṁ*], गं [*gaṁ*] etc.

(2) If a vowel is followed by *visarga*, for example, कः [*kaḥ*], गः [*gaḥ*] etc.

(3) If a vowel is followed by a conjunct consonant, for example, छन्द [*Chanda*]. Notice that the short syllable छ [*cha*] has to be counted long, since it is followed by the conjunct न्द [*nda*].

A more detailed discussion on short and long syllables is presented in *Chapter 2*.

Scansion*:* A scansion is a numeral representation of a metrical line. For example, consider a poetic line, 'बड़ा हुआ तो क्या हुआ', here,

बड़ा [*badā*] = ब [*ba*]+ ड़ा [*Dā*] = [*Laghu*, *Guru*] = [1, 2]

हुआ [*huā*]= हु [*hu*]+ आ [*ā*] = [*Laghu*, *Guru*] = [1, 2]

तो [*to*] = तो [*to*] = [*Guru*] = [2]

क्या [*kyā*]= क्या [*kyā*] = [*Guru*] = [2]

हुआ [*huā*] = हु [*hu*]+ आ [*ā*] = [*Laghu*, *Guru*] = [1, 2]

So, the scansion for the entire line will be **[**[1 2**]** **[**1 2**]** **[**2**]** **[**2**]** **[**1 2**]]**. In final scansion presentation, the commas have been removed to enhance the readability.

An introductory idea of short and long syllables has already been provided in the *chapter 1*. Here are some extended rules that will be useful in figuring out the instant counts in metrical compositions. Word scansions under the following would be helpful in understanding these rules.

- When a short syllable is followed by *anusvara* (ं) it converts to long. For instance, consider the following word scansions: अंक = [21], नहिं = [12], रंगीन = [221], फिरंगी = [122].
- When *anusvara* (ं) comes after a long syllable, its weight stays the same. For instance: नहीं = [12], जमींदार = [1221].
- Any conjunct consonant (without any diacritic mark) when appears as prefix is treated as a short syllable. For examples: स्वयं = [12], क्रम = [11], च्यवन = [111].
    - Instant value of this conjunct consonant, when appears with a short vowel, doesn't get changed. For example: त्रिवेणी = [122], क्रिया = [12], द्रुत = [11].
    - Instant value of this conjunct consonant, when appears with a long vowel, gets changed to ***2***. For example: स्त्री = [2], भ्रामक = [211], स्मारक = [211].
- A conjunct consonant when preceded by a short syllable alter its weight to ***2***. Example: सत्य = [21], विद्या = [22], मध्यम = [211].
- A conjunct consonant when preceded by a long syllable doesn't alter its weight. Example: माध्यम = [211], भास्वान = [221], रहस्य = [121].
- If a half syllable is followed by the letter ह [*ha*] in *guru* form, it becomes weightless in the corresponding scansion. Following examples would further clear this point.

  तुम्हें = [12], तुम्हारा = [122], जिन्हें = [12], जिन्होने = [122], कुम्हार = [121], कन्हैया = [122], मल्हार = [121], कुल्हाड़ी = [122], तन्हा = [12], दुल्हा = [12].

- However, if a half syllable is followed by the letter ह [*ha*] in *Laghu* form, then these two contribute one instant count in the corresponding scansion. For instance:

  अल्हड़ = [111], कुल्हड़ = [111], दुल्हन = [111], दुल्हिन = [111], कल्ह = [11], तिन्ह = [11].

Note: न्ह, म्ह, ल्ह are not conjunct consonants.